June, 1983

NOW IN OUR 35th YEAR

Phoenix Astronomical Society, Inc.

PHOENIX, ARIZONA

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<u>JUNE 11</u>

Star Party at the Filthy Five Inc. Park, Black Canyon City!!!!

IT'S CLOSE!!!

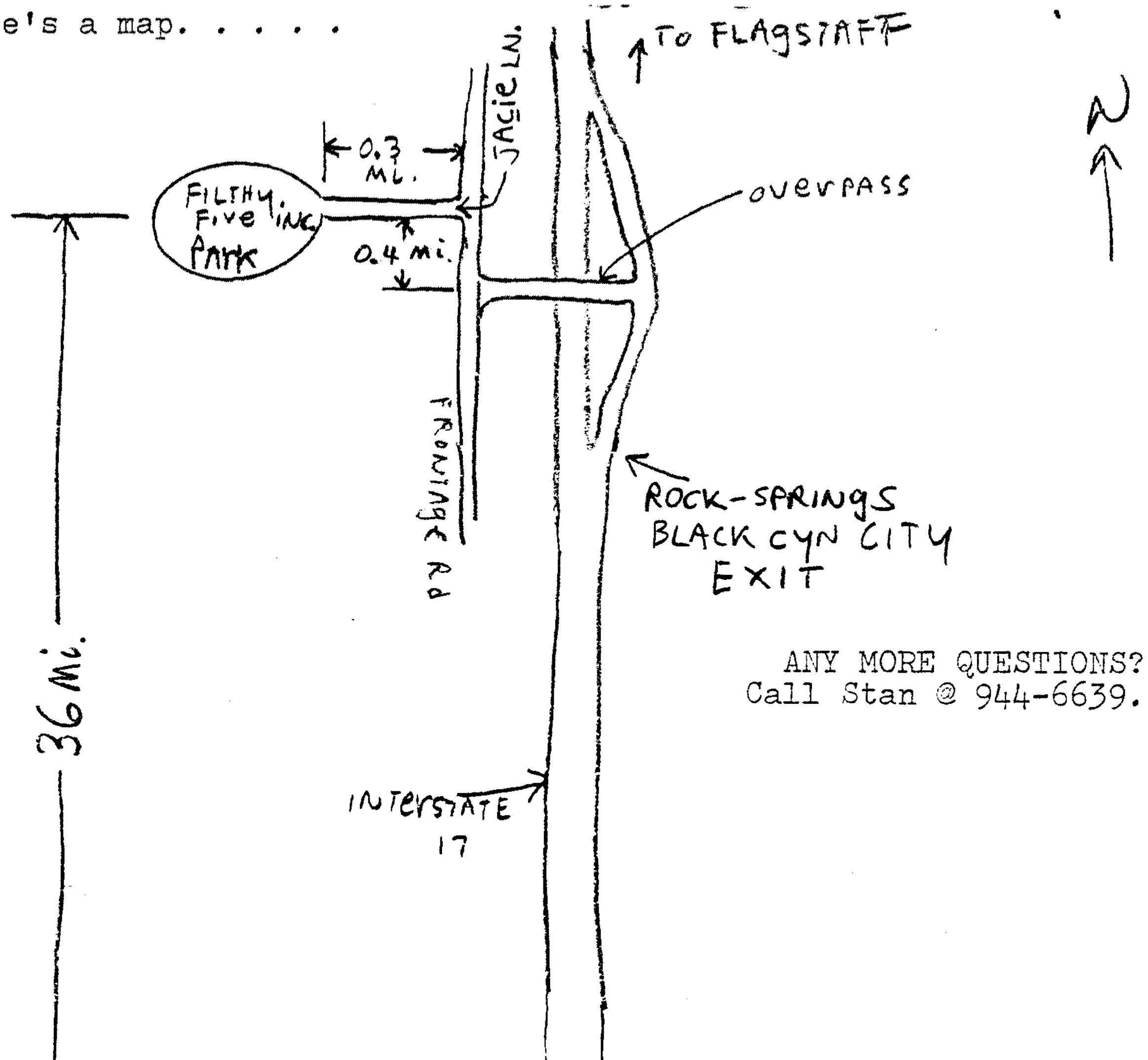
IT'S DARK!!!

IT HAS <u>RESTROOMS</u>!!!!!

But, that's not all!

There is a clubhouse at the park where you can rest, make coffee, or, even cook a meal! Plates, pots, pans and even silverware are available, and facilities to clean up when you're done. Arrival time is from 4 PM on, so there is plenty of time to cook, set up your scopes and visit.

Here's a map. . . . .



ANY MORE QUESTIONS?
Call Stan @ 944-6639.

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Following is a copy of a letter from the Solar Section of The Association of Lunar & Planetary observers.

I'm sure some of you may be interested in solar observing.

2) High Resolution Observations
Photography and drawings of individual centers of activity taking advantage of moments of best seeing.

Each observer will have different amounts and arrangements of time available for observing. However, there are different types of observations needed that make different and varying demands on the observer's time. There is a need for observers that can work a little each day as well as those who can only devote a day or two each month to solar observing.

Eventually, it is hoped that the Section will have enough observers around the world, at more or less regularly spaced intervals in longitude in both northern and southern hemispheres so that we will have continuous coverage capabilities. We are nearing that goal now with members in over a dozen countries.

Once each rotation a bulletin called the Rotation Report will be published by the Section. It will list all data that has been received by the Recorder during the previous rotation. The data will be listed by rotation number and SESC (Space Environmental Services Center*) Region number. Also, it will include qualitative notes about each observation. Observing hints, requests and information for the members of the Section will also be included in the Report. This Report will be sent to professional solar astronomers and researchers around the world. Others wishing this Report should send stamps or SASE's to the Recorder. (Please no more than ten at a time!) If you cannot send stamps contact the Recorder and some arrangements will be made.

An observers Handbook is available from the Section for $4.00 (U.S.) This cost is to cover the printing and postage, expenses that must be initially borne by the Recorder. The only requirement is that those wishing the Handbook be members in good standing with the ALPO. Those members, and those contemplating membership, in the Section who are in countries prohibiting the mailing of these fees may again contact the Recorder and special arrangements will be made.

The ALPO is not just a U.S.organization. It is at the service of amateur astronomers around the world. The active of all is welcomed. Those interested in finding out more about joining the ALPO should contact Walter H. Haas. Those who are already members and are interested in the Solar Section should contact the Recorder.

As has been shown, the demands in terms of time need not be great, but, because of the contributions to science and the pure pleasure of observing, the rewards are great.

Sincerely,

Richard E. Hill
Resident Observer
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* of the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA)

— SOLAR SECTION —
ASSOCIATION OF LUNAR & PLANETARY OBSERVERS
Recorder: Richard E. Hill
4632 E. 14th St., Tucson, AZ. 85711

Dear Fellow Observers,

The Association of Lunar & Planetary Observers (ALPO) has begun a new section that may be of interest to you.

The ALPO is a world wide organization of amateur and professional astronomers that observe solar system objects in a coordinated manner. Their observations are then pooled together and made available to amateur and professional researchers. The ALPO was founded in 1947 and is presently directed by Walter H. Haas. Since its founding it has become well known for its high quality observations of the moon and planets. But, in July, 1982 they expanded their observational program. The ALPO has embarked on an exciting new field of study, the study of our own star, the sun. This is an especially rewarding field of study for the amateur astronomer since the features of the sun are the most active and changing in the whole of the solar system. The work of the Solar Section of the ALPO will be the morphology of these features. The Section will not involve itself with any tabulation of daily relative sunspot numbers or radio flare patrols. This work is already being done around the world by several other groups. What this Section will do is study, visually and photographically, the structure and evolution of solar phenomena in white light. While monochromatic observations will be accepted and kept on file by the Recorder of the Section, such observations will be used to augment the white light observations. The full expansion of the Section into the fields of monochromatic, photometric, and spectroscopic observing will come about as the time, interest and abilities of the participating observers allow. There will be a further emphasis on the photographic observations since these are in great demand by the professional community. Drawings will play a secondary, but still important role.

The function of the Section will be to stimulate, coordinate, and promulgate the amateur work in the field of solar morphology. Beyond this the Section will provide the professional community with the reliable high quality observations of solar phenomena made by these amateurs. In this way amateur astronomers, by pursuing their interest, make valuable contributions to science. The Section has already been guided by the professional astronomers. For the most part they have been <u>very</u> supportive of the Section. They have suggested that the observations be pursued as follows:

1) Medium Resolution Observations

Whole disk photography and drawings for the purpose of determining accurate heliographic latitude and longitude to assess drift and rotational variations. Such observations in both white light and monochromatic light are useful.

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COMET IRAS - ARAKI - ALCOCK

Herman Andreson couldn't find it with the naked eye.
Ted Paoloni reported that it was a huge blob, big and diffuse with 20 X 60 binoculars.
Personally, I found it, but with difficulty from central Phoenix.
A local T.V. weatherman said on the evening of May 11th, "Big as the full moon. . . will look like a ball of cotton . . . will make several passes(!!!???)".
By far the most interesting and detailed account came from Stan Gorodenski: "On Monday night, May 9th, a trip was made to Black Canyon City to observe this unexpected event. With the naked eye, it appeared as a very obvious dim ghost-like circular object about the size of the full moon, near the bowl of the little dipper. I made observations with my 12$\frac{1}{2}$"'er at about 9PM, but although the sky was very transparent the atmosphere was very turbulent and the seeing was consequently not good. However, I did observe a bright nucleus with a broad fan-like tail radiating from it at my lowest magnification of 149x. Increasing magnification progressively to 722x did not bring out any detail. However, occassionally a sharp boundary layer in the vicinity of the nucleus appeared to almost flicker in and out.
In general it was a disappointing object, but an observer near Dewey, Arizona, thought otherwise. He could see it move across the background of stars with his 8" f/8. I have an F/15 which greatly restricts my field of view and, unfortunately, it had not occured to me to look for this.
Upon my return to my apartment in Sunnyslope at about 11 PM, I could just barely see it with the naked eye. The next two nights I could not see it at all with the naked eye from my apartment, even though it was supposed to have been brighter than Monday night."

If you feel you had an interesting encounter with this comet, please report it to the editor.

EARLY RETURNS FROM RIVERSIDE !!!

Jerry Maurer and Bob Buckner went, also Stan Gorodenski. Stan won an Honorable Mention for his portable observatory! His telescope, built by Bill Loumaster of Mesa, won an award for Unique Design! I am told that Arizona was well represented, with members of many clubs state-wide in attendance. Perhaps those of you who went could write me your experiances and impressions of the meet, for inclusion in the next newsletter.

JUNE STAR PARTY ON THE 11 th.
NEXT STAR PARTY WILL BE JULY 9 th.

Deadline for the July newsletter is June 28. Want ads, observations, telescope making notes or anything of an astronomical intrest are very welcome. Now's the time to see your name in print! Send your articles to:

Bill Krist
1205 E. Hubbell St.
Phx. Az.
85006

Please include your phone number in case I need to ask any questions. Thank you!